BJÖRN HARTMANN

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Research Fields

International Trade, Economic Growth, Structural Change

References

Prof. Reto Föllmi
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Prof. Dominik Sachs
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Prof. Francisco Buera
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Prof. Ákos Valentinyi
University of Manchester
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Education

2021–2027 **Ph.D. in Economics**, University of St. Gallen
Essays in International Economics
Committee: Reto Föllmi (*main*), Ferdinand Rauch, Dominik Sachs & Ákos Valentinyi
Visiting Researcher: *University of Manchester*, Dec 2025–Feb 2026 (host: Ákos Valentinyi)
Visiting Researcher: *Washington University in St. Louis*, Aug–Nov 2025 (host: Francisco Buera)
Beginning Doctoral Programme, *Study Center Gerzensee*, 2021– 2022 (Grade: 5.5/6.0)

2019–2021 **M.A. in Economics**, University of St. Gallen
Thesis: *Trade, Schumpeterian Growth, and Innovation* (Grade: 6.0/6.0)

2016–2019 **B.A. in Economics**, University of St. Gallen

Job Market Paper

Structural Change under Limited Growth Pass-Through

Abstract: *The speed of structural change has slowed over recent decades, while market power and aggregate markups have risen. This paper studies how changes in market structure contributed to this slowdown. I incorporate heterogeneous firms and variable markups into a model of structural change. Market power breaks the proportional link between productivity and prices: productivity improvements are only partly transmitted into lower sectoral prices, and the strength of this growth pass-through depends on the firm distribution. Sectors with a thicker upper tail of the firm distribution exhibit lower growth pass-through. I quantify the mechanism for the United States from 1980 to 2014 and find that growth pass-through declined in every sector as markups have risen. In a counterfactual with full growth pass-through, the expenditure share of services would have been 2.92 percentage-point higher by 2014, corresponding to an additional 31.4 % of reallocation over the sample period. The effect primarily operates through weaker transmission of productivity growth into prices in the industry sector.*

Working Papers

Income Distribution, Welfare, and the Patterns of Trade. with Reto Föllmi and Josef Zweimüller, *CESifo Working Paper 12107, 2025.*

Abstract: *We study how income inequality shapes prices, trade, and welfare in an open economy. We develop a two-country trade model featuring non-homothetic preferences and within-country income inequality. Firms face a trade-off between price and market size, generating an endogenous price schedule in which cheap necessities coexist with expensive luxury goods. Pricing-to-market is driven by firms' ability to allocate fixed costs across countries. In a North-South setting, the richer country bears a larger share of fixed costs, raising prices particularly for poorer consumers, leading to a Manhattan effect. Within-country inequality also affects trade: a mean-preserving spread shifts demand towards luxuries. In an open economy, pricing-to-market introduces an additional channel absent in autarky: firms shift a larger share of fixed costs toward the more*

unequal country, causing more consumers there to lose from rising inequality and propagating the effects of increased inequality to its trading partner. Allowing international arbitrage eliminates fixed-cost shifting and the Manhattan effect by imposing uniform pricing across countries.

Parallel Trade Policy in General Equilibrium. with Reto Föllmi and Josef Zweimüller
Abstract: *International arbitrage limits firms' ability to price discriminate across markets. Firms can respond not only by changing prices, but also by withdrawing from low-income markets altogether. We study the trade policy implications of this extensive margin response in a general equilibrium North-South model. Trade policy is a joint decision over trade barriers and parallel trade policy. When income differences are sufficiently large, allowing parallel trade induces some Northern firms to stop exporting to the South to preserve higher prices at home. Restricting parallel trade therefore expands market access in the South, lowers Southern prices, and improves its terms of trade. As a result, the South prefers to prohibit parallel trade, whereas the North prefers to allow it. Parallel trade also overturns conventional incentives over trade barriers: the South prefers positive trade costs because they weaken the arbitrage constraint and induce more Northern firms to export, while the North prefers free trade. When parallel trade is prohibited, both countries prefer free trade. The globally optimal policy combines free trade with a ban on parallel trade.*

Work in Progress

The Sources of Labour Market Change. with Reto Föllmi and Marc-Andreas Mündler

Conferences, Presentations & Workshops

2026 Brown Bag Seminar Manchester; PhD Seminar St. Gallen; In_equality Conference Konstanz; SSES Annual Meeting; Brown Bag Seminar St. Gallen
2025 Villars Workshop on International Trade; PhD Seminar St. Gallen; SSES Annual Meeting Zürich; Macro Seminar Washington University in St. Louis; PhD Seminar Manchester
2024 SSES Annual Meeting Lucerne; PhD Seminar St. Gallen; BiGSEM Doctoral Workshop Bielefeld

Employment

2021–present **Research & Teaching Assistant**, University of St. Gallen | Chair Prof. Föllmi
2020–2021 **Research Assistant**, University of St. Gallen | Chair Prof. Föllmi
2019–2020 **Research Assistant**, University of St. Gallen | Chair Prof. Königer

Teaching Experience

2021–present **Advanced Macroeconomics I: Growth and Innovation**, Master level
course assistant, tutor of exercise session, exam grading
2024–2025 **International Trade**, Master level
course assistant
2022–2024 **Microeconomics I**, biweekly exercise sessions, Bachelor level
2023–2025 **Macroeconomics I**, biweekly exercise sessions, Bachelor level

Awards and Grants

2025 **Mobility Fellowship for Doctoral Students**, University of St. Gallen (CHF 35'000)

Other Professional Activities

2023–present **Editorial Assistant**, *Aussenwirtschaft*

Skills

Languages: German (native), English (C2), French (C1)
Programming: R, Matlab, Stata, Github, LaTeX